Krista Day

Principal UX/CX Designer & Strategist

kristamday@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/kristamday · Minneapolis, MN · Remote / hybrid

Principal-level individual contributor with two decades of experience, leading through craft, strategy and influence rather than headcount. Sets UX direction for complex enterprise platforms, CRM systems, AI-enabled products and data-dense systems — framing the problem, prototyping the answer, and defending the decision to executive stakeholders. Raises the bar by mentoring designers and establishing the patterns, research practices and governance that outlast any single project.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership & Strategy	Product & Systems Thinking · Design Leadership & Mentorship · Executive Communication · Cross-Functional Alignment · Product Road Mapping
Design & Research	AI Interface Design · User Research & Usability Testing · Information Architecture · Interaction & Visual Design · Mobile-First Responsive Design · WCAG Accessibility
Tools & Tech	Figma (advanced components/libraries) · Axure (high-fidelity logic/programming) · HTML · CSS · JavaScript · CMS (WordPress, HubSpot) · Claude · Gemini · ChatGPT · Copilot

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX Service Designer

Nov 2026 — Present

Optum · Eden Prairie, Minnesota

Principal UX/CX Designer & Functional Manager

Nov 2022 — Oct 2026

UnitedHealthcare · Eden Prairie, Minnesota

- **Team leadership:** served as Functional Manager for an international UX/UI design team; provided strategic mentorship, performance guidance, and clear career development pathways.
- **AI innovation:** conceptualized, designed, and prototyped a generative AI feature for an enterprise call center CRM platform, translating complex AI models into intuitive, user-friendly experiences.
- **Core workflow optimization:** spearheaded the end-to-end UX/UI strategy for a high-traffic web and mobile application, directly optimizing workflows for Medicare Sales agents.
- **Platform integration:** oversaw product design for a net-new platform integrating dual CRM systems, an advanced shopping comparison engine, and intelligent AI capabilities.
- **Research & data architecture:** independently planned, executed, and synthesized user research, multi-platform usability testing, and information architecture strategies to drive iterative feature delivery.
- **Cross-functional alignment:** partnered with Product, Engineering, and Business leaders to align design delivery with long-term product roadmaps; presented and defended strategic design decisions to executive stakeholders.
- **Accessibility & ops:** embedded inclusive design principles and WCAG AA standards directly into the product lifecycle; utilized advanced Figma design system governance to accelerate time-to-market.

Principal UX Designer / Team Lead

Jul 2018 — Oct 2022

Optum · Eden Prairie, Minnesota

- **Team scale:** recruited and led a high-performing international team of 10 multidisciplinary professionals across UX, visual design, research, accessibility, and UI engineering.
- **Program strategy:** architected and executed program-level UX strategies that established scalable design patterns and platform-wide consistency across data-dense interfaces.
- **Stakeholder management:** steered alignment for a high-visibility enterprise program across a complex network of 50+ cross-functional stakeholders.
- **Governance & compliance:** founded the “UI Champions” cross-functional committee, scaling WCAG accessibility standards and design patterns across 6+ Agile scrum teams.
- **Platform modernization:** redesigned healthcare provider experiences, unified disparate Service Advocate desktop workflows, and created advanced data visualizations for the Agile Reporting Hub.
- **Core product design:** designed an enterprise-grade developer security platform from the ground up; architected executive-level analytics dashboards for the Health Plan Manager platform.

- **Advanced prototyping:** used Axure for high-fidelity, logic-driven prototypes to rigorously simulate, user-test, and validate complex interaction models before engineering handoff.

UX Designer
Sep 2015 — Jun 2018

Sun Country Airlines · Mendota Heights, Minnesota

- **Omni-channel design:** designed end-to-end user flows, intuitive interfaces, and omni-channel experiences across web and email platforms to align product design with business goals.
- **Search results architecture:** re-architected the Search Results Page and dynamic flight + hotel bundle experience — **+51% mobile conversion, +34% desktop, –15% exit rate**.
- **Development & testing:** architected, coded, and tested responsive HTML email systems, optimizing for cross-client rendering, performance, and user engagement.
- **Compliance:** championed and enforced WCAG AA accessibility standards across all digital touchpoints to ensure inclusive user experiences.

Web Designer
Mar 2013 — May 2015

Vanco Payment Services · Minnetonka, Minnesota

- **Ecosystem UX:** designed user interfaces for mobile (iOS/Android), kiosk interfaces, and data-dense giving/scheduling platforms.
- **Front-end execution:** developed and deployed front-end code (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) and custom CMS solutions utilizing WordPress and HubSpot.
- **Research & iteration:** conducted cross-platform user research, usability testing, and high-fidelity prototyping to rapidly iterate on complex workflows.

Earlier
2006 — 2013

Graphic design, web design & production roles

- Print and digital design, front-end production, and client-facing creative work across agency and in-house teams — the craft foundation the last decade of product work is built on.

SELECTED OUTCOMES

+51%
Mobile search-to-sale conversion
SUN COUNTRY AIRLINES

+21%
Feature delivery velocity
UNITEDHEALTHCARE

+24
NPS, personas program
UNITEDHEALTHCARE

10
Team led internationally
OPTUM

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts — Fine Arts 12/2006
St. Cloud State University

Associate of Applied Science — Interactive Media & Graphic Design 6/2012
Minnesota School of Business

Associate of Arts — General Studies 5/2005
St. Cloud State University

Graduated with Highest Honors · Dean’s List · Advertising Agency Federation (AAF) · Interactive Media and Graphic Design (IMGD) Student Association — Founder & President